

Mike Young

Senior Front-End Developer / Web Platform & Digital Experience Specialist

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PROFILE

Senior Front-End Developer & Designer with 19 years of experience building high-performance marketing websites and digital campaign assets for SaaS and financial brands. Specializes in translating Figma designs into pixel-perfect, responsive WordPress and modern component-driven web experiences. Actively integrates AI-driven tools into development and creative workflows to accelerate delivery and elevate output quality. Self-directed and equally comfortable owning full web properties solo or collaborating closely with distributed design and marketing teams, a natural fit for remote, async environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Architecture: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, SASS/LESS, PHP, Semantic Markup

Frameworks & CMS: AstroJS, WordPress (Custom Themes & Plugins), Oxygen Builder, Headless CMS, Tailwind CSS, jQuery, Bootstrap

Design & Prototyping: Figma, Adobe XD, UI/UX Design, Wireframing, Photoshop, Illustrator

Performance & Accessibility: Core Web Vitals, Lighthouse Optimization, WCAG 2.1 / AODA Compliance, Semantic SEO

AI Integration: Claude Code in Zed, Custom Claude skills & project instructions (CLAUDE.md), AI-assisted code review, AI-assisted prototyping

Tooling & Workflow: Git, Netlify, Google Tag Manager, Asana, Agile/Scrum

EXPERIENCE

ScalePad | *Front-End Developer* Mar 2022 – Jun 2026 · Toronto, ON

- Led the migration of the corporate SaaS marketing website from Webflow to WordPress alongside a company-wide rebrand; as sole front-end developer for the marketing division, owned architecture, development, and launch across 30+ pages and templates.
- Built a library of reusable page templates and components that let the marketing team build and publish pages on their own, cutting developer requests by 50% and shortening campaign turnaround from 10 to 4 days.
- Migrated site tracking to Google Tag Manager, consolidating a dozen tags and scripts into a single managed container so marketing could deploy and update tracking without code changes.
- Raised Google PageSpeed Insights performance scores by 20% and improved Core Web Vitals through caching strategy, CDN configuration, and automated image optimization, strengthening SEO and inbound lead generation.
- Engineered highly interactive bespoke landing pages and digital campaign assets from scratch using custom CSS and JavaScript, directly supporting major product launches and elevating brand positioning.
- Translated high-fidelity Figma mockups into pixel-perfect, high-performance web experiences with strict adherence to responsive design principles, brand standards, and WCAG accessibility guidelines.

- Integrated AI-assisted tools into daily development workflow, leveraging Gemini and Claude code review to accelerate build cycles, reduce repetitive overhead, and maintain higher output quality.
- Partnered cross-functionally with marketing, design, and product teams; used Asana to manage campaign pipelines, prioritize workloads, and ensure on-time delivery.

CI Financial | *Front-End Developer & Designer* Jul 2018 – Mar 2022 · Toronto, ON

- Built and maintained 10+ public-facing and internal web properties for one of Canada's largest independent wealth and asset managers, serving thousands of monthly visitors; shipped features from design through release as part of an Agile/Scrum team.
- Designed and developed dozens of static and animated HTML5 display banners and campaign assets for national programmatic campaigns, turning creative briefs into production-ready builds within ad-network file-size limits.
- Produced 20+ video and podcast episodes for the firm's digital channels, reaching thousands of viewers and listeners.
- Represented front-end engineering in corporate design reviews, flagging feasibility issues and refining UI details with designers and marketers before development, which reduced rework late in the build.

Intimate Interactive Advertising | *Lead Web Designer* Aug 2014 – Jul 2018 · Toronto, ON

- Managed a small front-end team through the full project lifecycle (requirements gathering, design, development, and maintenance) for a portfolio of lead-capture websites.
- Delivered modern, responsive websites using HTML, LESS, Bootstrap, and PHP, paired with custom logo, banner, and email design, to millions of monthly visitors.

Bluenotion Inc. | *Front-End Designer* Oct 2010 – Aug 2014 · Toronto, ON

- Designed and built responsive websites, microsites, and campaign pages for agency clients including Rogers, Manulife Financial, HarperCollins, and Mike Holmes.
- Turned design comps into cross-browser HTML, CSS, and JavaScript builds and WordPress templates, working directly with clients and developers from concept through launch on 20+ projects.

Booty Camp Fitness | *Design Director* Apr 2007 – Jun 2010 · Toronto, ON

- Built and maintained a national-reach website using HTML, CSS, PHP, and MySQL; handled all web, print, email, and video production for the brand.

EDUCATION

Conestoga College · UI/UX Design · 2026, Kitchener, ON

Humber College · Multimedia Design & Production Technician · Graduated 2005, Toronto, ON · Honours List

Humber College · Creative Photography · 2002–2003, Toronto, ON